

Advanced Level Statistics

Statistical Limit Theorems and Probability Distributions

1. Law of Large Numbers (LLN)

Definition

*As the number of trials increases, the **sample mean approaches the population mean**.*

If $X_1, X_2, X_3, \dots, X_n$ are independent random variables, the sample mean is:

$$\bar{X}_n = (1/n) \times \sum X_i$$

As $n \rightarrow \infty$:

$$\bar{X}_n \rightarrow \mu$$

μ = population mean

Interpretation

When an experiment is repeated many times:

- the **average result stabilizes**
- it becomes **close to the expected value**

Example

A fair coin is tossed many times:

Probability of head = 0.5

Number of Tosses	Proportion of Heads
10	0.6
100	0.52
1000	0.501

As the number of tosses increases:

Proportion of heads $\rightarrow 0.5$

Concept Diagram

Number of Trials $\rightarrow$ Large
|
v
Sample Mean

|
v
Population Mean

Sample Problem 1

A coin is tossed **2000 times** and heads appear **1020 times**. Find the experimental probability of heads.

Solution

$$P(H) = \text{Number of heads} / \text{Total tosses}$$

$$P(H) = 1020 / 2000 = 0.51$$

This value is **close to the theoretical probability 0.5**, illustrating the **Law of Large Numbers**.

2. Distributions Derived from Normal Distribution

Some important statistical distributions are derived from the **normal distribution**. These are widely used in **statistical hypothesis testing**:

- Chi-square distribution
 - t distribution
 - F distribution
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3. Chi-Square Distribution (χ^2)

Definition

If $Z \sim N(0,1)$, then:

$$U = Z^2$$

follows a **Chi-square distribution with 1 degree of freedom**. More generally:

$$\chi^2 = Z_1^2 + Z_2^2 + \dots + Z_k^2$$

follows a **Chi-square distribution with k degrees of freedom**.

Properties

- Always **positive**
- Skewed to the **right**
- Depends on **degrees of freedom**

Applications

Chi-square distribution is used in:

- Goodness-of-fit tests
- Independence tests
- Hypothesis testing

Example

Suppose observed frequencies differ from expected frequencies in a survey. The **Chi-square statistic** is:

$$\chi^2 = \sum (O - E)^2 / E$$

O = observed frequency

E = expected frequency

Sample Problem 2

Observed and expected frequencies — compute χ^2 .

O = {20, 30, 50}

E = {25, 25, 50}

Solution

$$\chi^2 = (20-25)^2/25 + (30-25)^2/25 + (50-50)^2/50$$

$$\chi^2 = 25/25 + 25/25 + 0$$

$$\chi^2 = 1 + 1 = 2$$

4. t Distribution

Definition

If:

$Z \sim N(0, 1)$

$U \sim \chi^2$ with n degrees of freedom

then:

$$T = Z / \sqrt{(U/n)}$$

follows the **t distribution with n degrees of freedom**.

When t Distribution is Used

The **t distribution** is used when:

- the population variance is **unknown**
- the **sample size is small**

Properties

- Symmetrical like normal distribution
- Has heavier tails
- Approaches normal distribution as sample size increases

Sample Problem 3

Given:

$\bar{x} = 52$ (sample mean)
 $\mu = 50$ (population mean)
 $s = 8$ (standard deviation)
 $n = 16$ (sample size)

Compute t.

Solution

$$t = (\bar{x} - \mu) / (s / \sqrt{n})$$

$$t = (52 - 50) / (8 / \sqrt{16})$$

$$t = 2 / (8/4) = 2 / 2 = 1$$

5. F Distribution

Definition

If $U \sim \chi^2(m)$ and $V \sim \chi^2(n)$ are independent variables, then:

$$F = (U/m) / (V/n)$$

follows the **F distribution with m and n degrees of freedom**.

Properties

- Always positive
- Used to compare **two variances**

Applications

F distribution is used in:

- ANOVA (Analysis of Variance)
- Comparing two population variances
- Regression analysis

Sample Problem 4

Given two sample variances, compute F-statistic:

$$s_1^2 = 16$$

$$s_2^2 = 9$$

Solution

$$F = s_1^2 / s_2^2$$

$$F = 16 / 9 = 1.78$$

6. Sampling Distribution

A **sampling distribution** describes the probability distribution of a statistic obtained from repeated samples.

Common sampling statistics:

- Sample mean
- Sample variance

Sample Mean

$$\bar{X} = (1/n) \sum X_i$$

Properties:

$$E(\bar{X}) = \mu$$

$$\text{Var}(\bar{X}) = \sigma^2 / n$$

Sample Variance

$$S^2 = (1/(n-1)) \sum (X_i - \bar{X})^2$$

It measures how much the sample values vary around the sample mean.

Standard Error of Mean

$$SE = \sigma / \sqrt{n}$$

Example

Sample size $n = 36$

Population mean $\mu = 80$

Population standard deviation $\sigma = 18$

$$SE = 18 / \sqrt{36} = 18 / 6 = 3$$

Sample Problem 5

A population has $\mu = 50$, $\sigma = 10$. A sample of size $n = 25$. Find the standard error.

Solution

$$SE = \sigma / \sqrt{n}$$

$$SE = 10 / \sqrt{25} = 10 / 5 = 2$$

Advanced Level Summary

Topics Covered

- ✓ Law of Large Numbers
- ✓ Chi-square distribution
- ✓ t distribution
- ✓ F distribution
- ✓ Sampling distributions
- ✓ Sample mean and variance
- ✓ Standard error